

# **OSINT INVESTIGATION REPORT**

**Organization:** Ecobank Ghana

**Course:** Thrive Africa Cybersecurity Internship

**Week:** Week 7 – OSINT & Threat Intelligence

**Group:** Group 3

**Confidentiality Level:** Internal Use Only

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## **1. INTRODUCTION**

This report presents the findings of an Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) investigation conducted on Ecobank Ghana. The objective of this investigation is to identify publicly available information that could pose cybersecurity risks if leveraged by malicious actors.

The assessment focuses on identifying exposed infrastructure, publicly available data, employee information, and potential social engineering vectors.

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## **2. OBJECTIVE**

- Identify publicly exposed information about the organization
  - Analyze how attackers can use this information
  - Highlight associated cybersecurity risks
  - Provide actionable security recommendations
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## **3. METHODOLOGY**

The investigation was conducted using passive OSINT techniques, ensuring no direct interaction with the organization's systems.

### **Tools & Techniques Used:**

- Google search and Google dorking
- LinkedIn analysis
- WHOIS lookup (Kali Linux)
- Public document analysis

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## **4. FINDINGS**

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### **◆ Finding 1 — Public Domain Registration Information**

**Category:** Infrastructure Exposure

**Finding:**

A WHOIS lookup revealed publicly accessible domain registration details, including registrar information, domain lifecycle data, and DNS infrastructure.

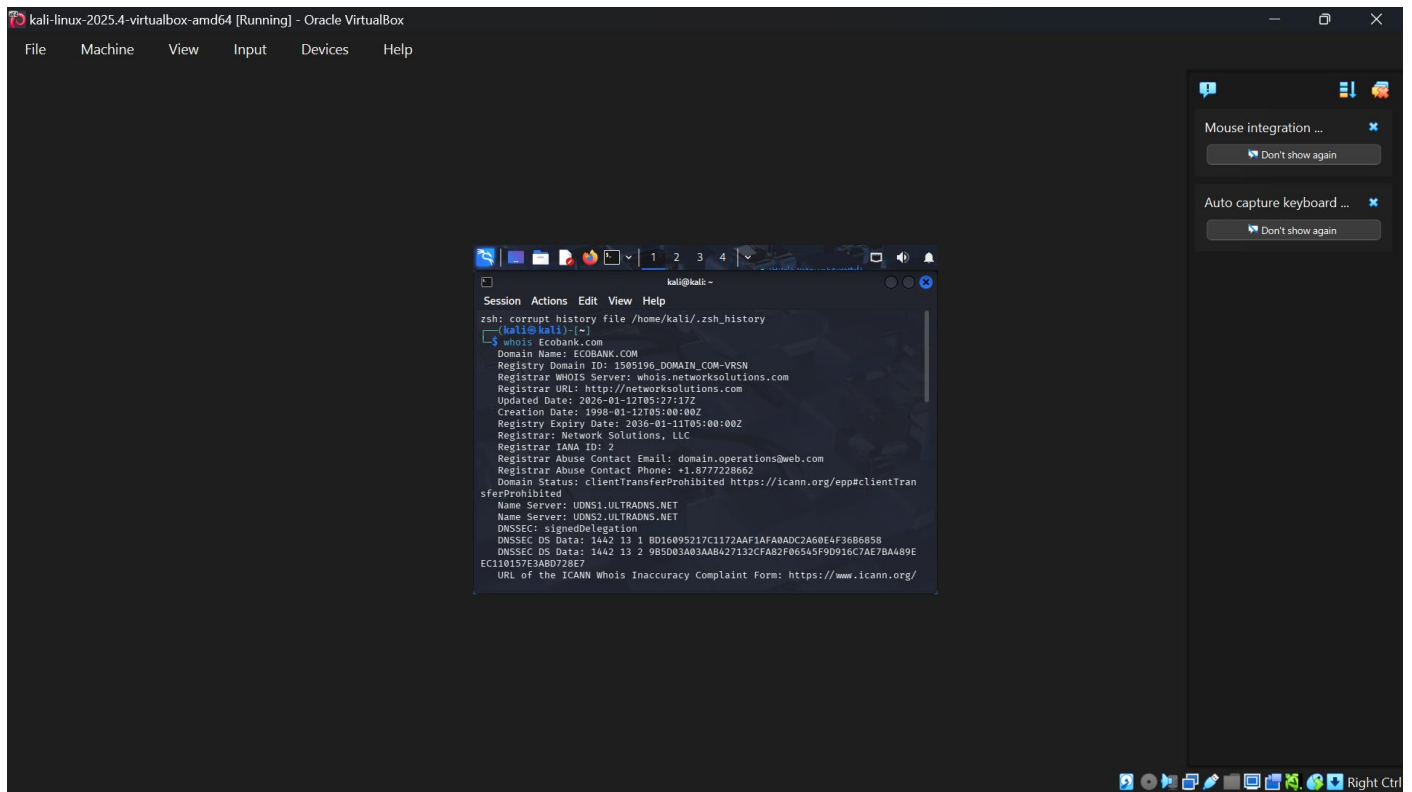
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**Risk:**

- Enables attackers to map infrastructure
  - Identifies DNS providers for targeted attacks
  - Supports phishing and impersonation attempts
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**Recommendation:**

- Monitor domain activity for suspicious changes
  - Implement domain monitoring and alerting
  - Limit exposure of sensitive registration data where possible
  - Use Domain Privacy Protection (where applicable)
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**Figure 1: WHOIS Lookup Result**

From the screenshot above, you have:

#### Key findings:

- **Domain Name:** ECOBANK.COM
  - **Registrar:** Network Solutions, LLC
  - **Creation Date:** 1998
  - **Expiry Date:** 2036
  - **Name Servers:** ULTRADNS (udns1.ultradns.net, etc.)
  - **Abuse Contact Email:** [domain.operations@web.com](mailto:domain.operations@web.com)
  - **Abuse Contact Phone:** + 1.8777228662
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## **◆ Finding 2 — Publicly Accessible Financial Forms**

**Category:** Information Exposure

### **Finding:**

Publicly accessible PDF documents, including account opening forms, were identified and can be downloaded without authentication.

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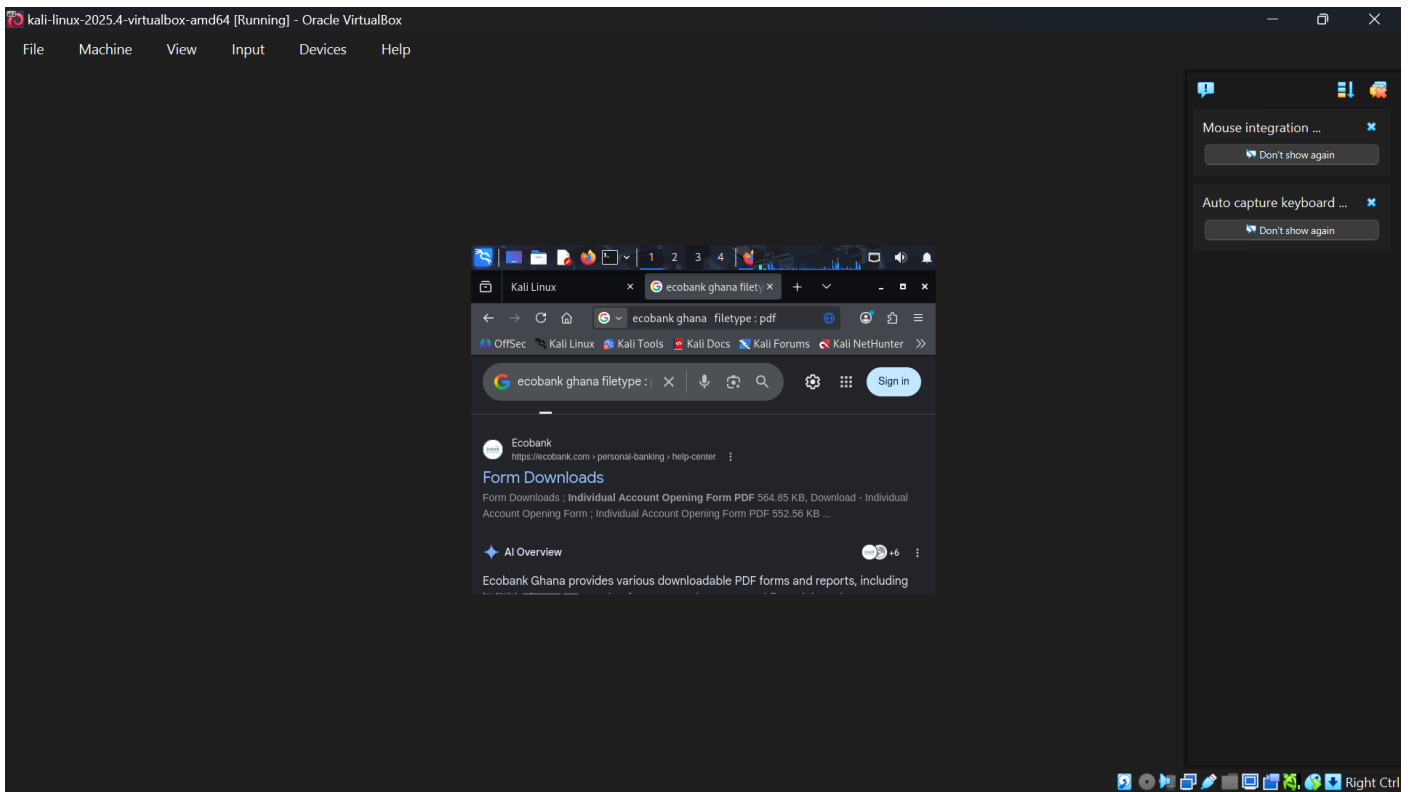
### **Risk:**

- Enables creation of phishing templates
- Reveals internal processes
- Supports fraud and impersonation

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### **Recommendation:**

- Add verification mechanisms to official documents
  - Educate users on identifying legitimate documents
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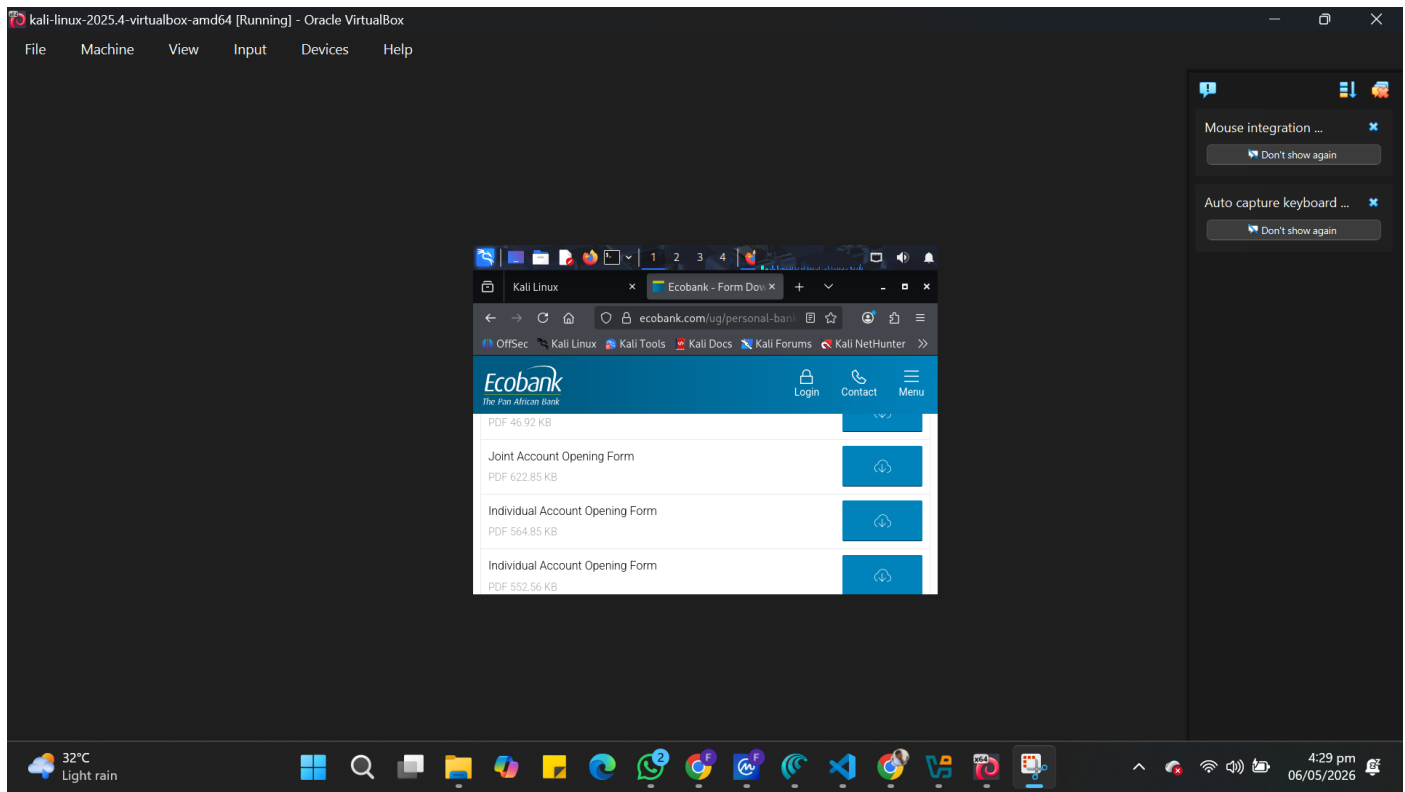


**Figure 2:** Using this google dorking technique, we typed and entered this search query; **ecobank Ghana filetype: pdf**, and we discovered a Form Downloads page directly from Ecobank

☞ **A Form Downloads page** from Ecobank

☞ It contains:

- Individual Account Opening Forms (PDFs)
  - Publicly downloadable documents
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**Figure 3:** This screenshot shows different downloadable forms such as a Joint Account Opening form

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### **◆ Finding 3 — Exposure of Sensitive Data Collection Structure**

**Category:** Data Exposure / Social Engineering

**Finding:**

Analysis of downloadable forms revealed structured fields requiring sensitive customer data such as identification details, personal information, and customer photographs.

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**Risk:**

- Facilitates phishing and identity theft
  - Enables attackers to replicate legitimate onboarding processes
  - Increases success rate of social engineering attacks
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**Recommendation:**

- Limit exposure of sensitive data structures
  - Use secure submission channels
  - Introduce document validation mechanisms
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**APPLICATION TO OPEN AN ACCOUNT**  
JOINT, PARTNERSHIP AND MINORS

Ecobank  
The Pan African Bank

TO: ECOBANK  (INDICATE COUNTRY NAME)

FOR BANK USE ONLY  
ACCOUNT N°

PLEASE READ CAREFULLY AND COMPLETE ALL RELEVANT SECTIONS. SHOULD YOU HAVE ANY QUESTIONS A MEMBER OF STAFF WILL BE HAPPY TO ASSIST YOU.  
(PLEASE COMPLETE IN BLOCK CAPITALS AND TICK WHERE NECESSARY)

**ACCOUNT SPECIFICATIONS**

NAME OF ACCOUNT:

TYPE OF ACCOUNT: ☐ JOINT ☐ PARTNERSHIP ☐ MINOR

CURRENCY OF ACCOUNT: ☐ CURRENT ☐ SAVINGS ☐ OTHER (PLEASE SPECIFY)

PURPOSE OF ACCOUNT: ☐ LOCAL CURRENCY ☐ OTHER (PLEASE SPECIFY)

REGISTRATION N° (IF APPLICABLE):

**Figure 4:** This image shows the Joint Account Opening form, type of accounts & currency

PURPOSE OF ACCOUNT: ☐ SALARY ☐ BUSINESS ☐ OTHER (PLEASE SPECIFY)

REGISTRATION N° (IF APPLICABLE):

RESIDENTIAL STATUS: ☐ RESIDENT ☐ NON-RESIDENT

**FIRST ACCOUNT HOLDER / GUARDIAN** **SECOND ACCOUNT HOLDER / MINOR**

**PERSONAL DETAILS**

TITLE: ☐ MR. ☐ MRS. ☐ MISS. ☐ DR. ☐ PROF. ☐ OTHER

SURNAME:

FIRST NAME:

OTHER NAME:

MAIDEN NAME (IF APPLICABLE):

FORM OF IDENTIFICATION: ☐ PASSPORT ☐ NATIONAL ID ☐ OTHER (PLEASE SPECIFY)

ID N°:

CUSTOMER PHOTO

**Figure 5:** This image clearly exposes sensitive data fields such as First Name, Surname, Title, Identification



Type (Passport, National ID), Identification Number, Customer Photo Section and other highly sensitive information.

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The screenshot shows a web browser window with the following elements:

- Tabs:** 'Kali Linux', 'Ecobank - Fo', and '0195\_GRP'.
- Address Bar:** 'Kali Linux' and 'upload/publication/20'.
- Page Content:**
  - DECLARATION**

The information which I have provided in this form is accurate and is valid at the date of opening the account. I have also fully read and understood the terms and conditions for operating an Ecobank Account as contained herein, and also the accompanying booklet as applicable and agree to be bound by all terms and conditions as applicable to the banking services applied for by me. I therefore request that you open an account and provide your services to me in line with the above information.
  - SIGNATURE:** Two empty text input fields.
  - JURAT (THIS SHOULD BE ADOPTED WHERE THE APPLICANT IS NOT LITERATE OR IS BLIND AND THE FORM IS READ TO HIM / HER BY A THIRD PARTY)**

I agree to abide by the contents of this agreement and acknowledge that it has been truly and audibly read over and explained to me by an interpreter.
  - MARK OF CUSTOMER / THUMBPRINT:** An empty text input field.
  - MAGISTRATE / COMMISSIONER FOR OATHS:** An empty text input field.
  - DATE:** A date picker showing '10/10/2020'.
  - NAME OF INTERPRETER:** A text input field.
  - ADDRESS OF INTERPRETER:** A text input field.
  - LANGUAGE OF INTERPRETATION:** A text input field.

**Figure 6:** This image shows the declaration section of the Joint Account Opening form

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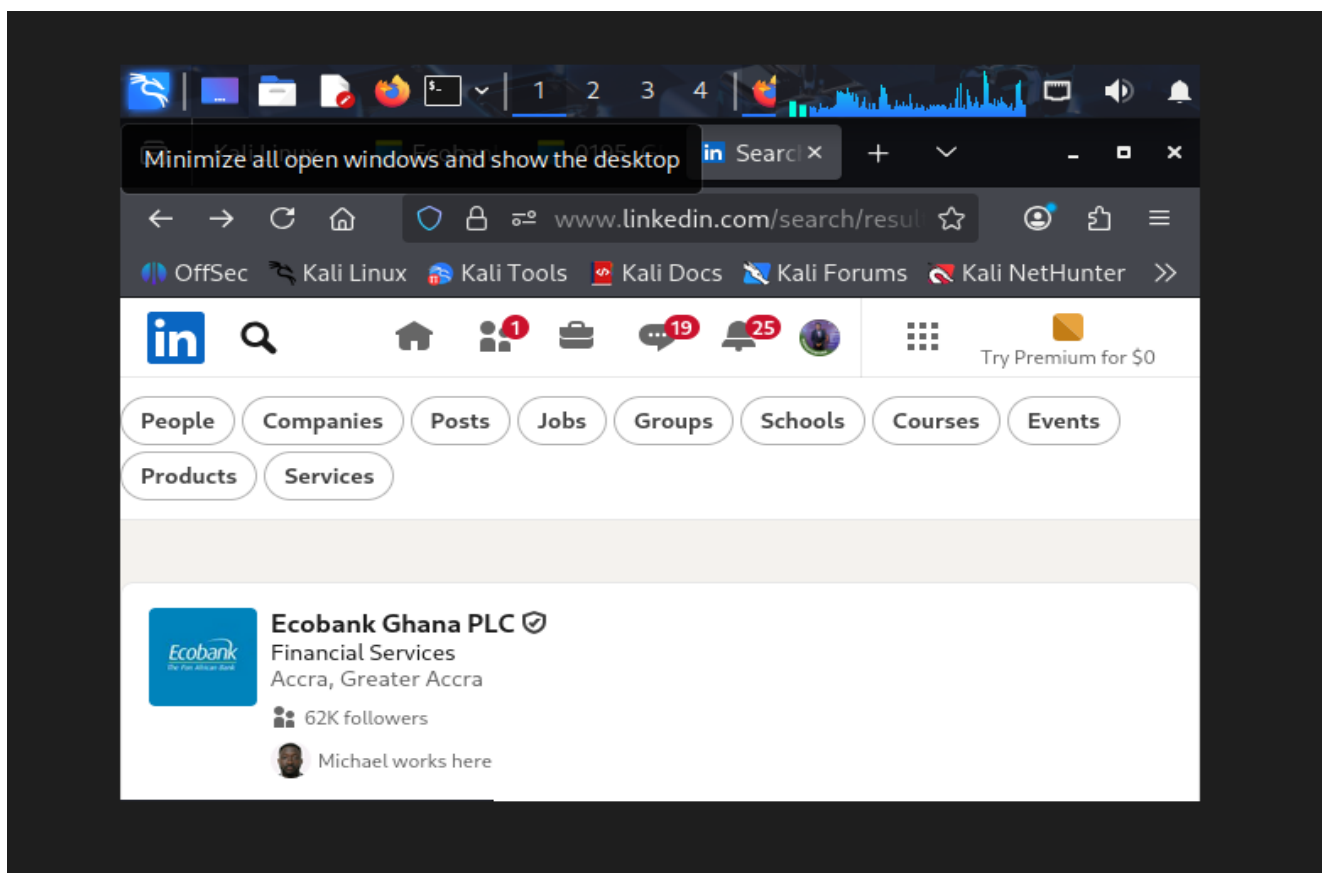
## ◆ Finding 4 — Publicly Available Employee Information

### Risk:

- Enables targeted spear phishing attacks
  - Allows impersonation of employees
  - Exposes high-value roles such as management and compliance
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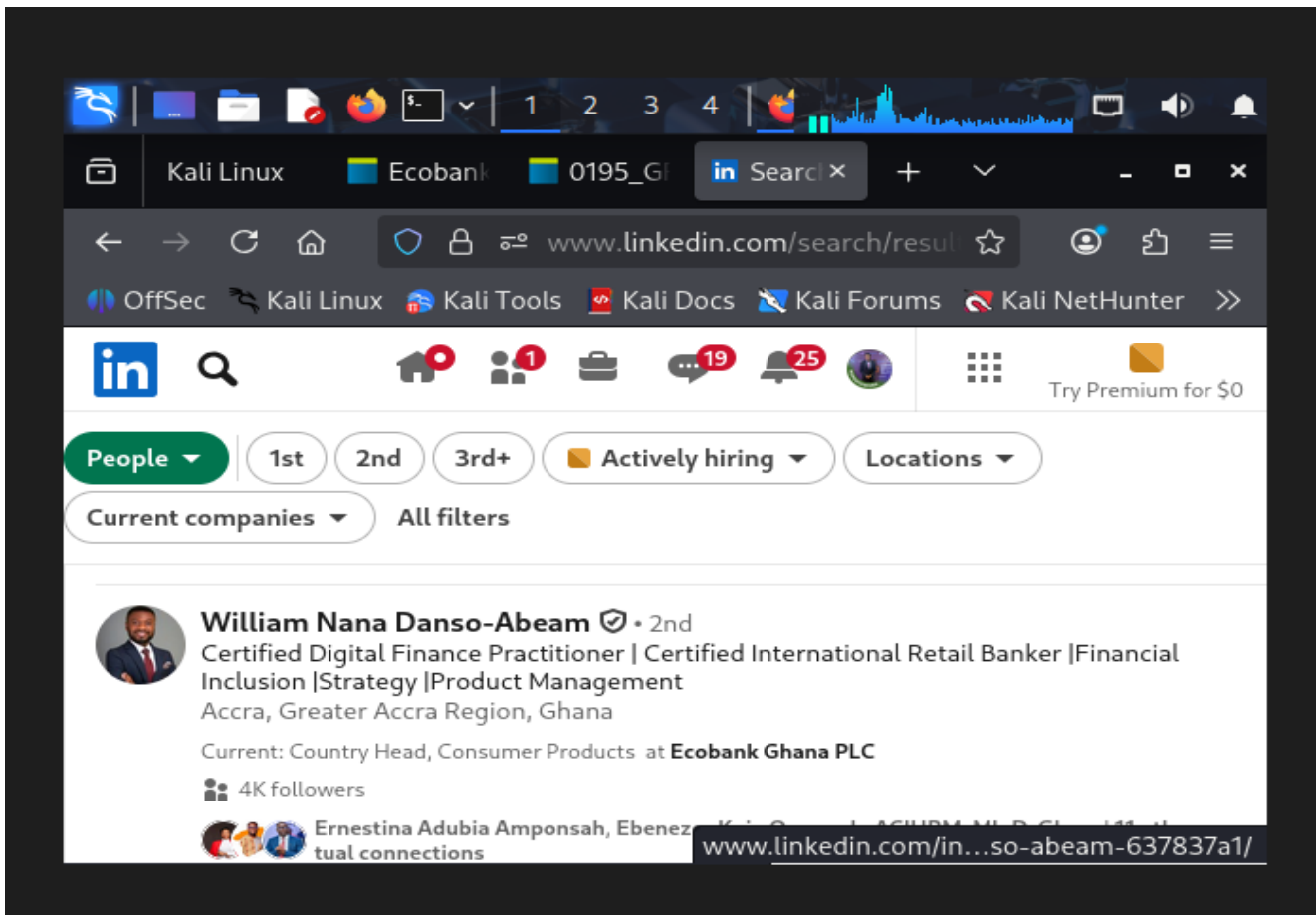
### Recommendation:

- Conduct employee awareness training
  - Limit exposure of sensitive job roles
  - Implement phishing detection and response mechanisms
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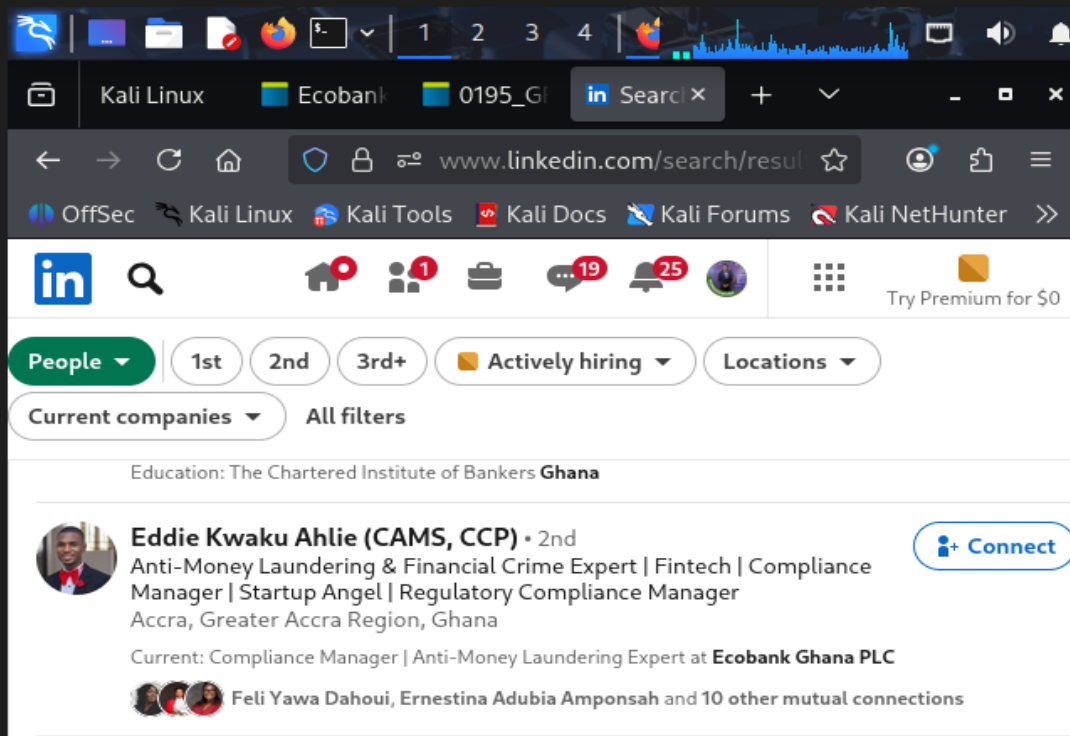
**Figure 7:** The image above shows my LinkedIn Search for Ecobank Employees

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**Figure 8:** This image shows an Ecobank Employee who is currently the Country Head for Consumer Products in Greater Accra Region using the search filter “**People**” on LinkedIn

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**Figure 9:** This image shows another Ecobank Employee who is a Compliance Manager as well as an Anti – Money Laundering & Financial Crime Expert

## 5. RISK ANALYSIS SUMMARY

| Risk Type              | Description                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Phishing               | Use of forms and employee data to deceive victims |
| Social Engineering     | Exploitation of employee roles and hierarchy      |
| Identity Theft         | Collection of sensitive personal information      |
| Infrastructure Mapping | Use of domain and DNS data                        |

## 6. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Implement security awareness training programs

- Restrict unnecessary public exposure of sensitive information
  - Introduce document verification mechanisms
  - Monitor for phishing and impersonation attempts
  - Strengthen internal communication verification processes
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## **7. CONCLUSION**

The OSINT investigation demonstrates that a significant amount of useful information about Ecobank Ghana is publicly accessible. While this information is not inherently malicious, it can be effectively leveraged by attackers to conduct phishing, social engineering, and fraud.

By implementing appropriate security controls and awareness measures, the organization can significantly reduce its exposure to these risks.

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## **8. FINAL NOTE**

Most cyber attacks do not begin with system compromise—they begin with information gathering. The findings of this report highlight how publicly available data can be used to build highly effective attack strategies without direct system access.